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Prof. Dr. Catherine De Wolf

Chair of Circular Engineering for Architecture (CEA)

Department of Civil, Environmental and Geomatic Engineering (D-BAUG)

ETH Zurich

Subject: Spontaneous application for research / PhD opportunities in Circular Engineering for Architecture

Dear Prof. De Wolf,

I am writing to apply spontaneously for PhD or research opportunities in your Chair of Circular Engineering for Architecture at ETH Zurich. In construction we are already good at taking buildings apart, but a lot of good material still ends up as waste. From what I understand, your group works on digital ways to document existing materials, recover components, match them to new projects, and check environmental impact. That is the kind of work I want to do. I would be happy to discuss whether there is a fit with current or upcoming openings in your group.

I hold a Master's in Environmental Engineering from HTW Dresden and a Bachelor's and Diploma in Civil Engineering. In my master's thesis, *Agile Project Management in the Construction Industry*, I studied how Agile can help construction teams work better together, manage risk, make decisions and use resources more carefully. Completing that work also opened a wider interest for me: what happens to materials when a building reaches the end of its life. Since then I have kept learning about circular construction, material flows and GIS, including how missing information often leads people to choose new materials instead of reused ones.

At Aug.e I worked on digital twins for smart buildings. We used a digital model to understand and improve how a real building performs. At Hive CPQ I managed large product datasets from manufacturers and turned complex information into simple tools that non-technical users could work with. At iostoring I worked with a construction partner on a circular construction hypothesis: how Agile project management can bring circular practices into real projects. From these roles I bring experience with construction data, stakeholders, digital tools and GIS. I have been on a career break to care for my newborns, and I kept learning about this field during that time.

CEA's focus on digital workflows for reuse matches my background well: reality capture and documentation of existing buildings, clearer information for material matchmaking, design that starts from reclaimed components, and life-cycle thinking to measure impact. I would like to contribute to research that helps make reclaimed materials a normal part of planning and delivery, not only a special case.

I am based in Pune, India, and open to relocating to Zurich for a doctoral or research role. I work in a calm and structured way, communicate clearly with technical and non-technical partners, and enjoy applied work with industry. I would welcome the chance to discuss opportunities in your group and to share how I could contribute and learn within CEA.

Yours sincerely,

Pooja Awasare